CLASS 5:
AI IN OPERATIONS.

The business around the product — how six industries actually use AI.

WHAT'S THE MOST REPETITIVE TASK YOU'VE AUTOMATED?



WHERE AI FITS AND WHERE IT DOESN'T.

FITS	High volume, clear rules, structured in and out, a human checks first.
DOESN'T FIT	Novel decisions, relationships, anything catastrophic if wrong once.
THE GREY ZONE	**Judgement calls that repeat. AI drafts, you approve, it improves.**

RULE **Automate the volume. Keep the judgement.**

HOW TO FIND THE SCOPE.

01

LIST

Every recurring task in one team, logged for two weeks. Steps, not process names.

02

MEASURE

Minutes × times per week = hours a month. The only number that ranks anything.

03

CLASSIFY

Rules, judgement or relationship. Rules automate. Judgement gets a draft-and-approve gate.

04

RANK

Hours saved × cost of an error. Build the top one. Ignore the rest for now.

RULE **Teams guess wrong about their own biggest time sink. Measure first.**

SHOULD YOU AUTOMATE THIS?

ASK	IF NO
Does it happen more than 10 times a week?	Do it by hand.
Is the input structured, or can you structure it?	AI-assisted, not automated.
Is a wrong output caught before it reaches anyone?	AI drafts, human approves.
Does automating cost less than doing it?	Not yet.

PROBLEM TO SOLUTION.

WHAT THEY SAY	THE SHAPE THAT FIXES IT
“We're too slow.”	`extract → validate → flag → approve`
“It costs too much.”	`batch pipeline on a schedule`
“We keep making mistakes.”	`rules engine + confidence threshold`
“We can't scale it.”	`process doc → agent + log`
“Customers wait too long.”	`classify → route → draft reply`

HOW TO FIND THE REAL PROBLEM.

“Walk me through the last time this went wrong.”	The real process, not the ideal one.
“Who touches this between request and done?”	Handoffs are where the cost sits.
“What happens if it’s late?”	No consequence means no budget.
“What do you check before you sign it?”	That check is the human gate you keep.
“Show me the file.”	The input format decides what’s possible.

LISTEN FOR **The step everyone dreads — not the step they describe first.**

WHAT BUYERS ACTUALLY PAY FOR.

01

COST PER TRANSACTION

Priced against headcount. Easy to sell, easy to measure, capped by what the team costs.

AP · support · claims intake

02

RISK AND COMPLIANCE

Priced against a fine, a failed audit or a stopped shipment. Highest willingness to pay.

KYC · certificates · audit trails

03

REVENUE SPEED

Priced against time-to-list, time-to-quote, time-to-close. Hardest to attribute, easiest meeting to get.

catalogue · proposals · lead qualification

MARKET **Crowded: chatbots and content. Open: anything touching a regulated document.**

MANUFACTURING: WHAT GETS AUTOMATED.

01
INVOICE MATCHING
Invoice against purchase order, mismatched lines flagged.

02
GOODS-IN CHECKS
Delivery photographed, damage and shortfalls flagged.

03
LINE INSPECTION
Camera spots defects on every unit, not a sample.

04
FAILURE WARNINGS
Sensor patterns predict a breakdown before it happens.

05
PRODUCTION REPORTS
Shift data becomes the daily summary automatically.

06
SUPPLIER CHASING
Late deliveries spotted, the follow-up drafted.

WHO BUYS **Plant manager and finance director. The budget sits with the plant, not with IT.**

MANUFACTURING: WHO OWNS IT.

Invoice checking

SAP

Matches invoices to orders inside the software factories already run.

WHY IT WINS

The invoice is already in their system.

Machine failure

SIEMENS

Sensors on machines that warn you before something breaks.

WHY IT WINS

Sold per machine, so no big project to approve.

Quality checks

AMAZON

Cameras check every item in the warehouse instead of a sample.

WHY IT WINS

Built it for themselves first, then sold it.

Two of the three won on distribution and pricing, not on the model.

RETAIL: WHAT GETS AUTOMATED.

01
PRODUCT LISTINGS
Spec sheet becomes a finished listing in minutes.

02
PHOTO TAGGING
Images sorted, attributes pulled out automatically.

03
DEMAND FORECASTING
Per SKU, per store, per week — not per category.

04
ORDER-STATUS REPLIES
The most common ticket, answered instantly.

05
REVIEW SUMMARIES
Thousands of reviews into one honest paragraph.

06
PRICE MONITORING
Competitor prices watched and flagged daily.

WHO BUYS **Head of e-commerce and the service lead. Measured in time-to-list and contact rate.**

RETAIL: WHO OWNS THIS SPACE.

Product listings

SHOPIFY

Writes product descriptions for sellers inside the store admin.

WHY IT WINS

Free with the platform, so nobody buys it separately.

Reviews and search

AMAZON

Summarises thousands of reviews into one paragraph.

WHY IT WINS

Owns the data nobody else can get.

Customer support

KLARNA

An AI assistant handles about two-thirds of support chats.

WHY IT WINS

Cut response time from minutes to seconds.

Watch the platform risk: if it ships free in Shopify, don't sell it separately.

FINANCE: WHAT GETS AUTOMATED.

01
DOCUMENT CHECKS
Passports and proofs read, verified, exceptions flagged.

02
FRAUD SCORING
Every transaction rated in milliseconds.

03
CLAIMS INTAKE
Photos, forms and calls into one structured file.

04
LOAN REVIEW
Covenants, ratios and deviations extracted.

05
ALERT TRIAGE
AML alerts ranked so analysts work the top.

06
CUSTOMER QUERIES
Balance and statement questions answered instantly.

WHO BUYS **COO and head of compliance. The budget is a risk line, not an efficiency line.**

FINANCE: WHO OWNS THIS SPACE.

Fraud

MASTERCARD

Scores every transaction for fraud in milliseconds.

WHY IT WINS

Decades of transaction data behind it.

Contracts

JPMORGAN

COIN reads commercial loan agreements in seconds.

WHY IT WINS

Built in-house. Core work never gets outsourced.

Claims

LEMONADE

Settles simple claims from a photo or a video in minutes.

WHY IT WINS

Built the whole insurer around the automation.

Utilities get bought. Differentiators get built. Know which one you're selling.

LEGAL: WHAT GETS AUTOMATED.

01
CONTRACT REVIEW
Key terms extracted, unusual clauses flagged.

02
DUE DILIGENCE
A data room summarised issue by issue.

03
RESEARCH MEMOS
A sourced first draft in minutes.

04
VERSION COMPARISON
Differences explained in plain English.

05
BILLING NARRATIVES
Time entries written from activity logs.

06
INTAKE CHECKS
New matters screened for conflicts automatically.

WHO BUYS **In-house teams buy faster than firms. Sell cost inside, capacity outside.**

LEGAL: WHO OWNS THIS SPACE.

Law firms

HARVEY

Research and drafting trained on a firm's own past work.

WHY IT WINS

Sells trust and security, not a smarter model.

Research

WESTLAW

An AI assistant inside the tool lawyers already pay for.

WHY IT WINS

Distribution beat the standalone product.

Agreements

DOCUSIGN

Pulls dates, renewals and obligations out of signed contracts.

WHY IT WINS

Already holds every contract you signed.

Sell to in-house teams. The billable-hour model works against you at firms.

HEALTHCARE: WHAT GETS AUTOMATED.

01
CLINICAL NOTES
Written from the consultation as it happens.

02
PATIENT MESSAGES
Replies drafted inside the medical record.

03
CODING AND BILLING
Codes suggested straight from the note.

04
PRIOR AUTHORISATION
The justification letter drafted from the record.

05
APPOINTMENT TRIAGE
Urgency ranked before anything is booked.

06
DISCHARGE SUMMARIES
Assembled from the chart, clinician signs.

WHO BUYS **Hospital COO and clinical leads. Long pilots, compliance review, high stickiness.**

HEALTHCARE: WHO OWNS THIS SPACE.

Clinical notes

MICROSOFT

Writes the doctor's note from the conversation in the room.

WHY IT WINS

Plugs straight into the medical record.

Patient messages

EPIC

Drafts replies and letters inside the medical record.

WHY IT WINS

Owns the workflow, so it owns the AI on top.

Symptom checks

ADA HEALTH

Asks about symptoms and ranks how urgent it is.

WHY IT WINS

Never diagnoses, so it clears regulation.

In healthcare, nothing gets adopted unless it lives inside the record.

LOGISTICS: WHAT GETS AUTOMATED.

01
CUSTOMS PAPERWORK
Documents read and checked before the port.

02
EXPIRY ALARMS
Certificates and licences watched, alerts sent early.

03
DELAY DETECTION
Plan against actual, escalation drafted.

04
PROOF OF DELIVERY
Photos and signatures filed automatically.

05
LOAD MATCHING
Freight matched to trucks and priced instantly.

06
FIELD REPORTS
Voice notes turned into structured job records.

WHO BUYS **Ops director. Sold on penalties and demurrage avoided, not on hours.**

LOGISTICS: WHO OWNS THIS SPACE.

Paperwork

MAERSK

Reads customs documents and flags anything expiring.

WHY IT WINS

One stopped container pays for the year.

Delays

DHL

Predicts delays and reroutes before the customer calls.

WHY IT WINS

Sold as penalties avoided, not hours saved.

Matching

UBER FREIGHT

Matches loads to trucks automatically, with instant pricing.

WHY IT WINS

Same playbook as the taxi app, for freight.

All three sell a number, not a capability.

WHICH PROCESS IN YOUR WORK HAS THE MOST MANUAL STEPS?

Could any of them be automated?



WHAT'S RUNNING ELSEWHERE AT SCALE.

HARVEY
Legal research and contract review for law firms.

JPMORGAN COIN
Loan agreements reviewed in seconds. Reported: 360,000 hours a year.

KLARNA
AI handles about two-thirds of customer service chats.

AMBIENT SCRIBES
Doctors dictate. AI writes the clinical note in real time.

UNILEVER
AI screens CVs in the first round of hiring.

DUOLINGO
AI generates exercises, explanations and stories. Smaller content team.

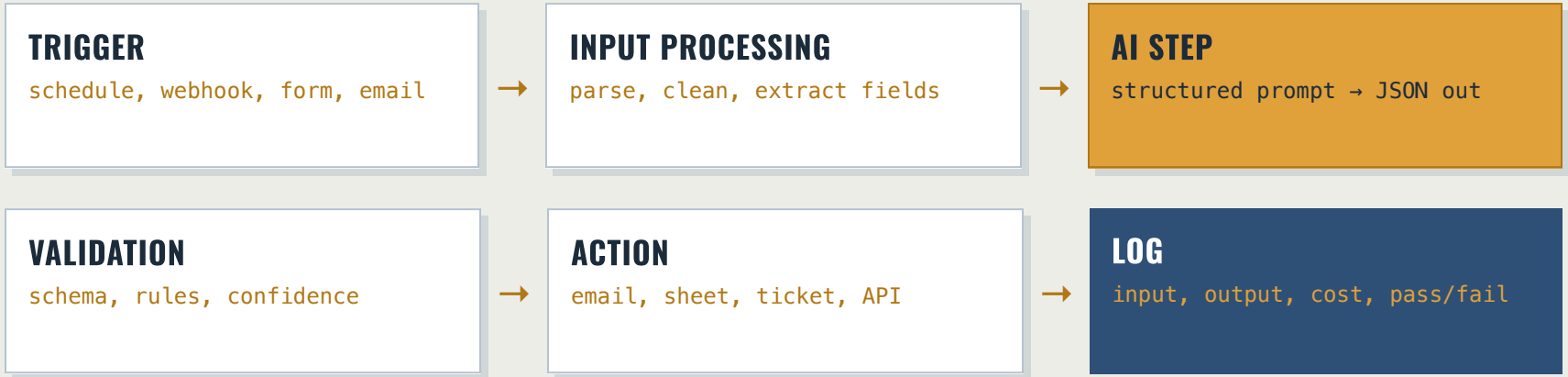
None replaced the expert. All replaced the volume work around the expert.

THE PATTERN ACROSS ALL OF THEM.

01	**STRUCTURED INPUT**	They didn’t automate chaos. They structured it first.
02	**HUMAN AT THE END**	Someone reviews before it matters. Every single one.
03	**STARTED NARROW**	**One task, proved, then expanded. Nobody launched a department.**

RULE **If you can’t describe the steps, AI can’t follow them.**

HOW THESE ACTUALLY GET BUILT.



n8n · Make · Zapier · custom scripts

Every automation is this diagram with different boxes filled in. Use the simplest tool that works.

BUILD YOUR PROCESS DOC.

```
I’m going to describe a process I do repeatedly. Interview me
step by step. For each step ask: what’s the input, what do you
do, what’s the output, and what could go wrong. At the end,
write it as a process doc I can hand to AI.
```

INTERVIEW, DON’T ASK.

The process doc is the spec for an automation.

WRITE YOUR FIRST AUTOMATION SPEC.

Pick the most repetitive task from your idea or your life. Write the process doc using the prompt from this class. Then decide: n8n, Make, Zapier, or a script?

THEN PICK YOUR TOOL.

WHAT'S THE FIRST AUTOMATION YOU'LL BUILD?

After this course.



THE ARC.

01	02	03	04	05
FIND THE PROBLEM	DECIDE WHAT TO BUILD	BUILD IT	SELL IT	RUN IT
Class 1	Class 2	Class 3	Class 4	Class 5

One idea, five classes, everything you need to start.

WHAT YOU LEAVE WITH.

01

A CONTEXT DOC

Your reality, updated.

02

A SPEC

One page, locked rules, a cost line.

03

A LAUNCH PLAN

Channel, sequence, support plan.

04

AN AUTOMATION SPEC

Your first process doc.

05

A WAY OF WORKING

Context first, check everything, decisions stay yours.

NOW GO BUILD SOMETHING.